

RENANCE

OSUN STATE UNIVERSITY, OSOGBO

NSG 531 — Past Questions & Materials

by Renance

Course: NSG 531

Institution: Osun State University, Osogbo

Papers in this pack: 1

Levels: 500

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Paper 1 of 1 — NSG531{GERIATRICNURSING}

Level 500 • First Semester • Handout

OSUNSTATEUNIVERSITY

DEPARTMENTOFNURSINGSCIENCE

NSG531{GERIATRICNURSING}

LECTURER:MRSFOLAMI

GROUP6

SLEEPANDAGING

GROUPMEMBERS

1. AFOLABIP.O2020/31410
- 2.ADELEKANM.A2020/31397
- 3.ADEBOWALET.R2020/31389
- 4.LAWALF.I2020/31447
- 5.RAZAQZ.O2021/34000
- 6.ALALADEB.O2020/31418
- 7.FOLAJINI.E2020/31436
- 8.AYODELEO.E2020/31427
- 9.BABATUNDEP.A2020/32363
- 10.OWOFADEJUOKEA.B.2020/31469
- 11.OLADIPUPOS.I2020/31458

SLEEPANDAGING

DefinitionofSleep

Sleepisaconditionofbodyandmindinwhichtheeyesareclosed,the postural muscles relaxed,the activity of the brain altered,and consciousness of the surroundings practically suspended.

TypesofSleep

ByFunction:

1. CoreSleep
 - Essentialforsurvivalandbasicfunctioning.
 - IncludesmostofthedeepsleepandsomeREMsleep.
2. OptionalSleep
 - Additional sleepbeyondcoresleep.
 - Helpswithrecoveryandoptimizationbutislesscritical.

ByBrainActivity:

1. RapidEyeMovement(REM)Sleepisastageofsleepcharacterizedby:
 - Rapidandrandommovementoftheeyes.
 - Increasedbrainactivitysimilartowakefulness.
 - Vividdreaming.
 - Temporarymuscleparalysis(exceptfortheeyesanddiaphragm).
2. Non-RapidEyeMovement(NREM)Sleep:
 - Eyemovementisminimalorabsent.

- Brain activity progressively slows.
- The body undergoes physical restoration.

NREM stages include:

1. Stage 1: Light sleep, a transition from wakefulness.
2. Stage 2: Moderate sleep, where the body begins to relax.
3. Stage 3: Deep sleep (slow-wave sleep), vital for physical repair and growth.

By Circumstances:

1. Polyphasic Sleep:
 - Sleep is broken into multiple segments throughout a 24-hour period.
 - Common in infants and some cultures.
2. Monophasic Sleep:
 - One long sleep period per night (common in adults).
3. Biphasic Sleep:
 - Two periods of sleep per day (e.g., a long night time sleep and a nap).
4. Segmented Sleep (First and Second Sleep):
 - Historically common, involving two distinct sleep periods with a wakeful interval in between.

Definition of aging

Aging can be defined as the time-related deterioration of the physiological functions necessary for survival and fertility. In simpler terms, it means growing older.

Sleep in relation to Aging

Sleep and aging are intricately linked, and understanding this relationship is crucial in geriatrics. As people age, their sleep patterns undergo significant changes that can impact their physical and mental health. Let's dive into the world of sleep and aging in geriatrics.

Normal Sleep Changes with Aging

1. Sleep Duration: Older adults tend to sleep less, with average sleep durations decreasing from 7-9 hours in young adulthood to 5-7 hours in older age.
2. Sleep Quality: Sleep quality often declines with age, leading to lighter, less restorative sleep.
3. Sleep Schedule: Older adults may experience changes in their sleep-wake cycle, leading to earlier bedtime and wake-up times.
4. Sleep Disorders: The risk of sleep disorders, such as insomnia, sleep apnea, and restless legs syndrome, increases with age.

Factors Contributing to Sleep Changes in Older Adults

1. Chronic Health Conditions: Conditions like arthritis, diabetes, and cardiovascular disease can disrupt sleep.
2. Medications: Certain medications, such as those used to treat depression, anxiety, and hypertension, can interfere with sleep.
3. Lifestyle Changes: Retirement, social isolation, and decreased physical activity can contribute to sleep changes.
4. Circadian Rhythm Changes: The natural dip in body temperature and melatonin release, which regulate sleep, can shift with age.

Consequences of Sleep Changes in Older Adults

1. **Cognitive Decline:** Poor sleep quality and duration can contribute to cognitive decline and increased risk of dementia.
2. **Mood Disturbances:** Sleep changes can lead to depression, anxiety, and irritability.
3. **Increased Risk of Falls:** Sleep disturbances can impair balance, coordination, and reaction time, increasing the risk of falls.
4. **Weakened Immune System:** Chronic sleep deprivation can weaken the immune system, making older adults more susceptible to illnesses.

Strategies to Promote Healthy Sleep in Older Adults

1. **Establish a Consistent Sleep Schedule:** Encourage older adults to maintain a regular sleep schedule, even on weekends.
2. **Create a Sleep-Conducive Environment:** Ensure the sleep environment is dark, quiet, and cool, and invest in a comfortable mattress and pillows.
3. **Encourage Physical Activity:** Regular physical activity can help promote better sleep, but avoid vigorous exercise within a few hours of bedtime.
4. **Manage Chronic Health Conditions:** Effective management of chronic health conditions can help alleviate sleep disruptions.
5. **Avoid Stimulating Activities Before Bedtime:** Discourage stimulating activities like watching TV, using electronic devices, or engaging in intense conversations before bedtime.
6. **Consider Cognitive Behavioral Therapy for Insomnia (CBT-I):** CBT-I is a non-pharmacological approach that can help older adults address underlying sleep-related issues.

Geriatric Sleep Assessment and Intervention

1. **Comprehensive Geriatric Assessment:** Conduct a comprehensive assessment to identify underlying sleep-related issues, including medical, psychological, and social factors.
2. **Sleep Diaries and Actigraphy:** Use sleep diaries and actigraphy to monitor sleep patterns and identify areas for improvement.
3. **Non-Pharmacological Interventions:** Implement non-pharmacological interventions like CBT-I, sleep restriction, and relaxation techniques.
4. **Pharmacological Interventions:** Consider pharmacological interventions like melatonin or sedatives, but use them judiciously and under close supervision.

Future Directions in Geriatric Sleep Research

1. **Personalized Sleep Medicine:** Develop personalized sleep interventions tailored to individual older adults' needs and preferences.
2. **Technology-Based Sleep Interventions:** Explore the use of technology, such as wearable devices and mobile apps, to promote healthy sleep in older adults.
3. **Sleep and Cognitive Function:** Investigate the relationship between sleep and cognitive function in older adults, including the potential for sleep interventions to prevent or slow cognitive decline.

Conclusion: Sleep and aging are complexly intertwined, and understanding these changes is essential for promoting healthy aging. By recognizing the factors contributing to sleep changes, addressing the consequences of sleep disturbances, and implementing effective strategies to promote healthy sleep, we can improve the quality of life for older adults.